

Parabens



What is it?

Parabens are preservatives. They are in many cosmetics. They are also found in some topical medications.

There are 5 common parabens: methyl -, ethyl -, propyl -, butyl -, and benzyl -.

PARABENS can also be known as:

Methylparaben

Ethylparaben

Propylparaben

Butylparaben

Benzylparaben

Other sources may list the chemical name, which has the same beginning, but ends with:

- - parahydroxybenzoate

OR

- - parahydroxybenzoic acid

instead of paraben.

Some Possible Uses of PARABENS / Where it might be found:

- Moisturizing lotion, cream
- Make up
- Make up remover
- Facial cleanser, cleansing pads
- Body wash, soap, foam
- Shampoo, conditioner
- Hair styling gel and mousse
- Hair color

- Toothpaste
- Deodorant, anti-perspirant
- Shave gel or cream
- Hair removal
- Cuticle remover
- Quick dry nail product
- Sunscreen, spray tan
- Acne treatment
- Cold sore remedy
- Anti-itch lotion
- Nipple ointment and balm
- Vaginal medication
- Personal lubricant
- Hemorrhoid remedy
- Diaper rash ointment
- Athlete's foot cream
- Shoe polish
- Ultrasound gel
- Unna boot dressing or bandage
- Gel like toys, toy slime
- Pet shampoo
- Glues
- Metal working fluid, oil

Parabens may be found in some of these topical medications:

- Topicals for the eye, ear, or nose
- Topical skin medications, such as:
 - Adapalene
 - Benzoyl peroxide
 - Brimonidin



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Parabens



- Clindamycin
- Clo cortolone
- Desonide
- Fluocinolone acetonide
- Fluorouracil
- Fluticasone
- Hydrocortisone
- Hydroquinone
- Imiquimod
- Ivermectin
- Metronidazole
- Oxymetazoline
- Roflumilast
- Ruxolitinib
- Salicylic acid
- Sertaconazole
- Sodium sulfacetamide
- Tazarotene
- Tretinoin
- Urea
- Prescription barrier creams
- Local anesthetic
- Azo/disperse dyes (especially orange and yellow)
- 4,4 - diaminoephnylmethane (common in plastic eyeglass frames)
- Hydrochlorothiazide
- Sulfa drugs

What should I do to avoid PARABENS?

Do not use products that contain any of the parabens. Check the complete ingredient list of everything you use. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredients are found on the internet at the manufacturer's or store's website.

Tell your partner, hairdresser, doctor, nurse, and others to avoid items containing this allergen in your care. To find a possible work place exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product that you encounter. Wear gloves if you must come in contact with parabens as you care for others.

For additional information on medications, please refer to: dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/

Other products that might react like PARABENS:

Rarely, cross reactions can occur to other para amino compounds, such as:

- Para phenylenediamine (hair dye)
- Benzocaine group anesthetics
- Para - aminobenzoic acid (PABA) family of sunscreens

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

REVISION DATE: NOVEMBER 2025

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